RUSSELL DUDEK

ROBOTICS PRODUCT MANAGER · FOOD AUTOMATION, FIELDED SYSTEMS, LAUNCH READINESS

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LAB37

ROLE-ALIGNED CANDIDATE MATERIALS

TURN FIELD TRUTH INTO PRODUCT DECISIONS.

Operator-technologist with 20+ years across fielded robotics, food and grocery launch execution, software-enabled equipment, electromechanical manufacturing, customer operations, and AI-assisted decision systems. Strongest at translating ambiguous customer, operator, food-process, and machine signals into roadmaps, requirements, acceptance criteria, release readiness, pilots, dashboards, and operating cadence.

ROBOTICS PRODUCT PROOF

~1,000 FIELDED ROBOTS Connect telemetry, machine-vision context, support, engineering issue flow, quality, production, ERP, training, and leadership review.	**FOOD FULFILLMENT + LAUNCH** Served on the Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods, earned a Food Safety Management certification, and led high-volume Prime execution.
ELECTROMECHANICAL DEPTH Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, validation, documentation, supplier handoffs, and high-reliability technical programs.	**PRODUCT ARTIFACTS** Build PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, review gates, dashboards, decision records, agentic workflows, and human approval.

EXPERIENCE

DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS · VAPE-JET / PDX TECH SERVICES

Pittsburgh / Remote · 2025–Present

Lead product-facing operating transformation in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment.

- Connect field signals, customer support, non-reported error codes, production, quality, purchasing, software issue flow, Jira, ERP/Odoo, training, and leadership review into clearer triage and release-readiness mechanisms.
- Translate operational and customer evidence into requirements, acceptance criteria, documentation, owner gates, dashboards, and recurring cross-functional decisions.
- Lead cadence across engineering, production, quality, purchasing, support, training, customer operations, and leadership while remaining hands-on in the workflows and evidence.

OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT / SITE LEADER · AMAZON

Pittsburgh · 2014–2018

- Led launch and execution for Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods, connecting rapid food and grocery fulfillment to staffing, flow, quality, escalation, and customer-promise execution.
- Earned a Food Safety Management certification while at Amazon and applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS AND ENGINEERING MANAGEMENT · COMPUNETICS

Pittsburgh · 2000–2013

- Progressed through R&D program, production, acquisition, operations, and director-level leadership across advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, complex assemblies, documentation, validation, lifecycle controls, root-cause practices, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

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ROBOTICS PRODUCT MANAGER · CONTINUED

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ROLE-ALIGNED CANDIDATE MATERIALS

FOUNDER / AI AND AUTOMATION ADVISOR · DUDEWORTH

Pittsburgh · 2017–Present

- Develop AI-readiness and product-opportunity frameworks spanning value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Design agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Create product briefs, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, review mechanisms, prototypes, and measurable operating models.

REGIONAL DIRECTOR · CARDINAL BUILDING PRODUCTS

Pittsburgh · 2021–2023

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced machine-learning-enabled routing and decision-support concepts connecting service coverage, dispatch trade-offs, operating controls, and delivery economics.

CHIEF PILOT, AUTONOMOUS SYSTEMS AND AERIAL DATA OPERATIONS · ZEUSVU

Pittsburgh · 2018–2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

HOW I WOULD CONTRIBUTE

- Own multi-year roadmap inputs through customer discovery, market research, competitive analysis, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, success metrics, release readiness, and post-launch iteration.
- Lead external pilots as the primary customer interface from scope and onboarding through rollout, evidence review, and roadmap close.
- Bridge mechanical, electrical, firmware, software, cloud, UX, culinary, food-safety, manufacturing, commercial, operator, and customer decisions.
- Connect system KPIs to business cases, ROI, pricing assumptions, and deployment economics.
- Translate one product truth for executives, investors, customers, partners, and live demos.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Robotics · Telemetry · Machine Vision · Edge AI · IoT · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · Jira · Confluence · ERP/Odoo · HubSpot · Slack · GIS

CREDENTIALS

Google AI Essentials · Food Safety Management Certification · IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner · Six Sigma Certification · OSHA 10

EDUCATION AND ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP

Bachelor of Science · University of Pittsburgh — academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Chairman of the Board · Enviro Social Capital (2014–2017) · **CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair · IEEE** (2012–2016)

TRANSFERABILITY FOR LAB37

Fielded robotics + food fulfillment and safety literacy + electromechanical manufacturing + product decision systems create a system-level product advantage for making robotic food production dependable, measurable, and scalable.